

To: Editors-in-Chief and Action Editors, Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR)

From: Sham Thakare (Corresponding Author)

Date: August 12, 2026

Subject: Submission of Manuscript: "*Predicting Reinforcement-Learning Plasticity of Intermediate Language-Model Checkpoints: A Cross-Architecture Diagnostic Study*"

Dear Editors-in-Chief and Action Editors,

We submit our manuscript entitled "**Predicting Reinforcement-Learning Plasticity of Intermediate Language-Model Checkpoints: A Cross-Architecture Diagnostic Study**" for consideration as a research article in the Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR).

In accordance with JMLR submission guidelines, we confirm the following required declarations:

- **Prior Publications and Overlap Disclosure:** This manuscript presents original research that has not been published in any peer-reviewed conference or journal. It is not currently under consideration at any other publication venue.
- **Author Consent Confirmation:** As single author, I have reviewed and approved the manuscript and consent to its submission to JMLR.
- **Conflict of Interest Declaration:** I declare no competing financial or personal conflicts of interest regarding this work.
- **Candidate JMLR Action Editors (Subject Fit):**
 - **Prof. Quanquan Gu** (UCLA) — Optimization, reinforcement learning, and language model training dynamics.
 - **Prof. Nan Jiang** (UIUC) — Reinforcement learning theory, sample efficiency, and policy optimization.
 - **Prof. Qiang Liu** (UT Austin) — Multi-objective optimization and deep learning dynamics.
- **Candidate Reviewers (Subject Fit):**
 - **Dr. Arpit Bansal** (University of Maryland) — Intermediate RL training and language model plasticity.
 - **Dr. Rishabh Agarwal** (Google DeepMind) — Reinforcement learning efficiency and empirical evaluation.
 - **Prof. Percy Liang** (Stanford University) — Foundation model training dynamics and capability evaluation.
- **Keywords:** reinforcement learning, large language models, training dynamics, optimization, compute allocation.

Thank you for considering this manuscript.

Sincerely,

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